Have you encountered any specific challenges in your career related to gender, and how did you overcome them?

Joining our family business presented a notable challenge, particularly considering my position as the youngest member and a woman. Gaining acceptance from both the family and the established team proved to be a significant hurdle. To establish my role, I undertook tasks such as computerizing the hospital and upgrading facilities. I aimed to challenge stereotypes, demonstrating that women excel not only in HR but also in overall management. Beyond the hospital, I participated in various councils and chambers, even serving on the Quality Council of India. Despite concerted efforts, the mindset casting doubt on women's capabilities in significant roles persists. This mindset impedes the advancement of women, as seen in the healthcare sector where, despite comprising half the workforce, they struggle to attain high positions. The glass ceiling remains apparent, with only a few women managing to break through to CEO-level roles. I have personally confronted such limiting beliefs, illustrating how these barriers obstruct the progress of women.

What advice would you offer to women encountering similar challenges in their professional lives?

Two key issues are commonly encountered by women when entering any field, not just healthcare. Often, there are questions about our ability to work or travel late hours. It's crucial to believe in ourselves. If these demands don't align with us, perhaps considering a different path might be better. For example, in fields like marketing, comfort isn't always guaranteed.

I recall an incident where some women demanded preferential treatment based on gender, asserting they deserved special seats. I intervened, questioning why such requests were made when we advocate for equality. Personally, I do not seek assistance while traveling and manage my luggage independently. There seems little reason to request help in such matters. If we proclaim empowerment, it should be reflected in our actions, not just words. My advice is to believe in yourself, and work tirelessly—success doesn't come easily; it's a stairway to climb, not a lift to ride.

Have you employed specific strategies or practices to maintain a healthy work-life balance?

Upon joining, I assumed responsibility for overseeing the Kaushambi branch. Despite efficiently managing its operations, occasional whispers suggested my presence was solely due to family ties. Determined to dispel this notion, I sought to prove my merit by pursuing courses offered by NABH, and WHO, participating in programs at IIM Ahmedabad, and undergoing leadership training at Harvard.

Throughout this journey, encounters with successful women imparted a crucial lesson: deep knowledge is fundamental. In my field, specifically within healthcare, claiming expertise in patient safety and quality requires genuine understanding, not just certification. Much of my progress can be attributed to supportive seniors who positively shaped my initial experiences.

My message to aspiring individuals is straightforward: pursue what you love, coupled with a commitment to mastering your craft. During my early days, balancing a demanding workload with caring for my young son meant enduring 12-hour workdays and starting at 5 AM. There is no substitute for hard work in achieving goals. While I can now set boundaries, back then, creating my identity demanded relentless dedication.

How would you describe your leadership style, and what values do you prioritize in your leadership role?

A great leader can steer an organization through various approaches. Each department needs its own leadership style, tailored to its unique challenges. In my experience, fostering an approachable atmosphere is crucial. No one should feel intimidated by titles; I've always encouraged open communication. While a leader sets the vision, it's essential to embody it, not just on paper but in actions.

In my hospital, we emphasize being patient-friendly. I personally engage with patients, addressing their needs. For instance, if I spot someone requiring assistance, I take the initiative without delegating. Through such actions, I've instilled this behavior as part of our culture. When colleagues witness these gestures, it becomes ingrained in our collective ethos.

Leadership is about actions, not just words. It's vital to exhibit desired behaviors, embedding them within the organization's fabric. It's not merely about articulating a vision but living it through actions and demeanor.

What projects or initiatives are you enthusiastic about in the near future?

Our recent undertaking, Yashoda Medicity in Indirapuram, represents a significant milestone. The structure stands tall, awaiting interior design and the installation of machinery. This venture aims to revolutionize healthcare in North India, bringing together cutting-edge technology, especially in cancer care, and consolidating state-of-the-art equipment not seen collectively under one roof in Southeast Asia.

Our primary focus is on providing top-notch facilities. We are establishing a 250-bed ICU with modular OTs and equipment sourced exclusively from Dräger, a renowned German company. In the field of radiology, we are incorporating the latest equipment available worldwide. While Yashoda Kaushambi currently handles kidney transplants, this project extends to include heart and lung transplants—a rarity in North India.

Our commitment extends to embracing new surgical technologies, aligning with the essence of this 1200-bed hospital. We are dedicated to delivering the best healthcare at affordable rates. Yashoda has always been synonymous with affordability, a value close to our hearts due to our humble backgrounds. We take pride in incorporating schemes like Ayushman Bharat, ensuring even the less privileged have access to high-quality care.

Our dream is to blend cutting-edge technology with affordability, making healthcare accessible to all. Yashoda Medicity aspires to uphold this as its unique selling proposition. We are determined to turn this dream into reality, striving to deliver exceptional healthcare services to our community.